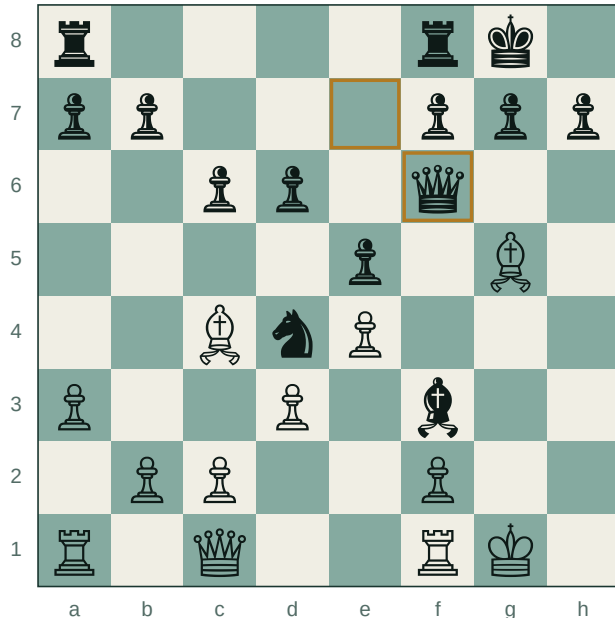


Clearance tactics: White, move 16

Clearance tactics

White to move



Previous move: 15...Qf6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

16. Bxf6 Ne2+ 17. Kh2 Nxc1 18. Rg1

16.Bxf6 The bishop captures the queen on f6. Recorded reply: **16...Ne2+**.

17.Kh2 The king moves from g1 to h2. Recorded reply: **17...Nxc1**.

18.Rg1 The rook moves from f1 to g1.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 24 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -2 to -2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g8. Absolute pin: pawn on f7.